

Your Builder's Toolkit

Everything you need to build with Claude Code — what to install, how to set it up, and what each tool does.

Step 1: Install VS Code

VS Code is your workspace — where your files live and where you'll talk to Claude Code.

1. Go to **code.visualstudio.com**
 2. Click **Download** (it detects your operating system automatically)
 3. Open the downloaded file and follow the install prompts
 4. Launch VS Code
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Step 2: Install Claude Code

Claude Code is your AI coding partner. It lives inside VS Code.

1. In VS Code, click the **Extensions** icon in the left sidebar (it looks like four squares)
 2. In the search bar, type **Claude Code**
 3. Click **Install** on the Claude Code extension
 4. Once installed, the Claude Code icon appears in your sidebar — click it to open
 5. Click **Sign In** and log in with your Anthropic account (Pro, Team, or Max plan required)
 6. Test it: type "Hello, can you hear me?" — if Claude responds, you're set
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Step 3: Install Wispr Flow (Recommended)

Wispr Flow lets you talk to Claude Code with your voice instead of typing. Optional but highly recommended.

1. Go to **wispr.com** and download Wispr Flow
2. Install and open it
3. Follow the setup prompts (grant microphone access when asked)
4. Test it: activate Wispr Flow, speak a sentence, and watch it appear as text

Step 4: Create Your Accounts

These are free and you'll need them later in the course.

GitHub — Cloud backup for your code

- 1. Go to **github.com**
- 2. Click **Sign Up** and create a free account
- 3. Choose a username and verify your email

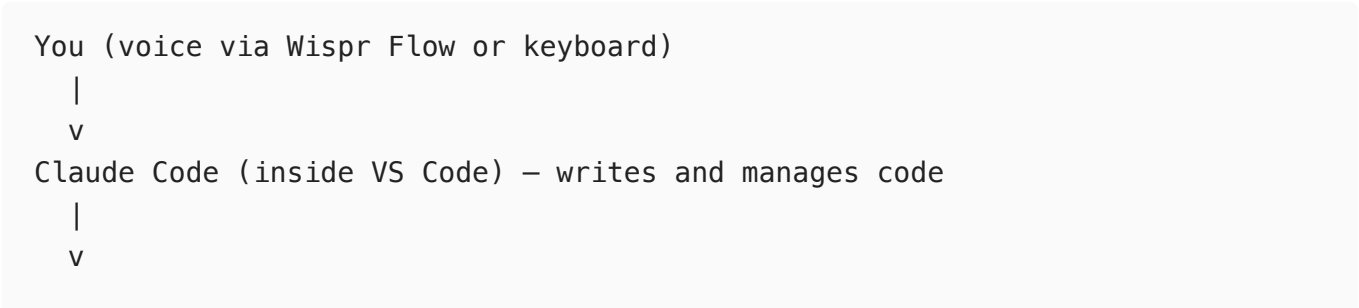
Vercel — Puts your app on the internet

- 1. Go to **vercel.com**
- 2. Click **Sign Up**
- 3. Sign up with your GitHub account (this connects them automatically)

What Each Tool Does

Tool	What It Is	Plain English
VS Code	Your workspace (IDE)	The app where everything happens — files, code, Claude Code
Claude Code	AI coding partner	You describe what you want, it writes the code
Wispr Flow	Voice dictation	Talk instead of type — faster and more natural
GitHub	Cloud backup	Saves your code online so you never lose it
Vercel	Deployment	Puts your app on the internet with a shareable link

How They Work Together



GitHub – backs up your code to the cloud
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Vercel – deploys your app to a live URL

Quick Actions Reference

I want to...	Do this
Open a project	VS Code → File → Open Folder → select your project
Talk to Claude Code	Click the Claude Code icon in VS Code's sidebar
Save my work	Tell Claude Code: <i>"Commit my changes and push to GitHub"</i>
See my app locally	In VS Code's terminal: <code>npm run dev</code> → open <code>localhost:3000</code>
Deploy my app	Tell Claude Code: <i>"Deploy this project to Vercel"</i>
Get help with an error	Paste the error into Claude Code and ask what's wrong